

M01 Quick Reference - RC1

Retrieval sheet, not a substitute for practice

DE01-01 What data is: tables, records, fields and data types

A row/record represents one observation at the table grain. | A column/field stores one attribute consistently across rows.

DE01-02 Grain: what one row represents

Write a grain sentence before calculating anything. | Different tables can describe the same business at different grains.

DE01-03 Keys, duplicates, NULLs and missing data

A primary/business key should uniquely identify the intended grain. | Repeated customer IDs can be valid in order data.

DE01-04 Data quality dimensions and validation thinking

Completeness checks required fields. | Uniqueness checks keys, not every repeated value.

DE01-05 Meet Excel: workbook, worksheet, cells and formulas

Workbook = file; worksheet = tab. | Cell addresses combine column letter and row number.

DE01-06 Enter, save and structure tabular data safely

Keep one untouched raw copy. | Use one header row with unique column names.

DE01-07 Sort and filter without damaging data

Filter hides rows; it does not delete them. | Sort the whole table/range, not one isolated column.

DE01-08 Basic formulas and essential functions

Start formulas with =. | Use cell references instead of hard-coded numbers when inputs already exist.

DE01-09 Relative and absolute references

Relative A2 changes when copied. | Absolute \$H\$2 stays fixed.

DE01-10 Excel Tables and structured data habits

A Table is an Excel object, not just colored cells. | Headers remain explicit and filters are built in.

DE01-11 Practical cleaning and lookup awareness

TRIM/CLEAN-like operations address whitespace/control characters. | Case standardization can reduce label inconsistency.

DE01-12 PivotTable and Power Query awareness

PivotTables summarize data quickly by dimensions/measures. | Power Query records repeatable transformation steps.

DE01-13 Chart choice and basic visual communication

Use bars/columns for category comparison. | Use lines for ordered time trends.

DE01-14 Reconciliation, sanity checks and source preservation

Record source row count and key totals before transformation. | Reconcile calculated totals to an independent method where possible.

DE01-15 Mini workflow: inspect -> calculate -> validate -> explain -> save evidence

Read the business question before choosing tools. | State grain and checks.